

MOONSHOT

GENERATION PROMPT SHEET

The eight shots in the 3:00 animatic that came out of a generator rather than a camera. All eight are in the cut; each still wears a red GENERATE tag so it is never mistaken for footage we own. The pages that follow carry the exact string that made each one, house look included, ready to paste.

To re-roll one: `tools/video/generate.py --only <slug> --force`. Nothing else in the cut moves. Deliver 16:9, 1920x1080, 30fps, no audio, longer than the slot with handles at both ends – every one of these is cut to the frame against a score that cannot be trimmed. Veo makes that automatic: at 1080p it only produces 8-second clips, longer than every slot here.

Veo 3.x has no negative prompt field, so the avoid-list is folded into each prompt as properties the image has. For Runway or Kling, which do take negatives, the separate list is in `docs/generation-prompts.md`.

THE 10

QUOTA	0:10.0	4.5s	vibe 5-6	YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER	IN THE CUT
LAB	0:35.6	3.5s	vibe 10-11	THEIR POWER WAS CUT	IN THE CUT
RITUAL	0:43.4	6.5s	vibe 11-16	ZVEN RITUAL – SOURCE NEEDED	IN THE CUT
AIM	0:49.9	3.0s	vibe 16-22	THE MOONSHOT – THE BEAMS REACH THE MOON	IN THE CUT
METER	1:22.1	3.0s	vibe 77-78	THE METER IN THE DOORWAY	IN THE CUT
INSPECTORS	1:38.1	4.5s	vibe 71-46	1 – WELLNESS INSPECTORS ARRIVE	IN THE CUT
DARK	1:52.3	6.0s	vibe 25-63	5 – DANCING IN THE DARK	IN THE CUT
POWER	1:58.3	3.5s	vibe 63-26	THEY CUT THE POWER	IN THE CUT
AFTERMATH	2:19.4	5.0s	vibe 0-54	3 – THE AFTERMATH	IN THE CUT
RESTORE	2:24.4	3.0s	vibe 54-84	THEY PLUG IT BACK IN	IN THE CUT

10 shots · 42.5s of 180 · 24% of the film

github.com/freematerial/moonshot-the-movie

YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER

The conflict before the film has a hero, stated in words a child can read off the wall. Not a safety measure – a bill. The great thing was achieved, the account was closed, and what is left is a world charged for what a finished world costs. The same two words come back at 2:46 as the machine's own reading.

NOTE – The readout is NOT generated. Veo will not render two lines of this length – asked for both it dropped the first, asked again it invented glyphs. The plate below supplies the panel, bezel, grain and halation; the text is drawn over it by the 'quota' treatment in animatic.py, where the wording lives in L_QUOTA_1..3. Change the line there, not here. Re-rolling this prompt only re-rolls the panel.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static macro, filling the frame, on the amber LCD of a wall-mounted domestic utility panel in a dark empty hallway at night. The display shows two lines of blocky dot-matrix text. The first line, large and centred, reads: YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER. Beneath it, in smaller text, a second line reads: NEW LIMIT: WHAT A FINISHED WORLD NEEDS. Both lines stay on screen for the whole shot. A relay clicks and the hallway lights step down one level. No people, no camera move. Available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome with only the amber display in colour. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. The only text anywhere in frame is the readout described above, in its own display, correctly spelled and sharp enough to read. No captions, subtitles, logos or watermarks. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THEIR POWER WAS CUT

The inciting incident, and it is a bill. Racks powering down mid-run, work abandoned in place. What follows is not mysticism, it is the same experiment run on the only supply nobody is charging for. V.O.: "We have no power. So we have no machines."

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Interior of a small cluttered laboratory at night. A rack of computers powers down row by row, cooling fans winding to silence, status LEDs going out one bank at a time until only emergency lighting is left. Papers and coffee cups abandoned mid-work on the bench. No people in frame. Locked-off static wide, no camera move. Available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome, the last LEDs the only colour. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

ZVEN RITUAL — SOURCE NEEDED

The meditation circle with the crossed blue beams is the most credible image in the film and the contest cut contains 1.9 SECONDS of it (16.0–17.9). This act wants thirty. Candles, beams, the circle, biosensor headbands going on. The beams have to leave the structure – that is the moonshot – but asking one clip for the interior and the exterior got us the interior and nothing else, twice. The exterior is its own shot now, immediately after this one, and this prompt covers the circle only.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Twenty people seated cross-legged on floor cushions in a circle around a cluster of candles, inside a temporary tabernacle built of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting, faceted into an octagonal chamber and erected inside a larger dark hall. Two crossed blue laser beams overhead, EEG headbands being fitted. Very slow push-in, interior only. Near-monochrome except the blue beams and the candle flames. Heavy grain, available light. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THE MOONSHOT — THE BEAMS REACH THE MOON

The one image the film is named after and did not contain. The beams leave the roof and converge on the moon, so the aim is a fact rather than a claim. Without it Act II is a séance; with it the room is pointing at something, and the title card at 2:54 has something to refer back to.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static wide exterior at night, locked off, the whole subject inside one frame. Low in the frame, a temporary octagonal structure of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting glows from within. Two blue laser beams punch up through its roof and rise across a clear night sky to a large bright full moon high in the upper third of the frame, where they converge to a single point on its face and stay there, connecting the building to the moon in an unbroken line. Nothing moves except drifting haze in the beams. No people in frame. Near-monochrome except the blue beams; the moon bright and detailed. Heavy grain, available light. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THE METER IN THE DOORWAY

The measurement arriving before the enforcement. Nobody reacts to it – the party does not know it is being assessed, which is the point. The glove and the greatcoat cuff are the first sight of the antagonist's uniform, sixteen seconds before the people wearing it walk in.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

A calibrated sound-level meter held at arm's length in a raw timber doorway, red LED reading 96.4 dB, the interior of a candlelit tabernacle of pine framing and silver mylar strobing out of focus behind it. The hand wears a black leather glove and the cuff of a heavy dark wool greatcoat shows at the wrist; the hand is steady and unhurried. Shallow depth – the meter sharp, the celebration soft. Night, available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. The only text anywhere in frame is the readout described above, in its own display, correctly spelled and sharp enough to read. No captions, subtitles, logos or watermarks.

1 — WELLNESS INSPECTORS ARRIVE

The field staff, and they have to read as *his* people at a glance or the film has two unrelated problems instead of one antagonist. Same heavy dark greatcoat, same wide collar, same black leather gloves as the man in the corridor, worn identically by all four – the costume is the only thing that says they are a side. They arrive in a line and stop in a line. Still unhurried and still pleasant, because the calm is the menace, but now they are writing citations, which is the visible form of the argument: not a raid, an assessment.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Four officials – four different faces, different ages and builds, men and women – dressed in identical heavy dark wool greatcoats with wide collars, shoulder tabs and black leather gloves, walking in a single line through a low timber doorway into a hazy candlelit tabernacle of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting at night. They stop together and stand shoulder to shoulder in a row facing the room, unhurried and calm, every coat the same. The nearest one holds a citation pad, writes on it, tears off a printed ticket and holds it out. Their expressions are mild and pleasant. Nobody hurries and nobody is armed. Handheld, available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome, slow walk-in. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame.

5 — DANCING IN THE DARK

Runs the reversal exactly: 25 up to 63. The low end comes back with it and so does the colour. The hope beat, immediately before the kill.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

A dense crowd dancing hard in near-total darkness inside a timber-framed chamber hung with silver mylar, lit only by one or two phone torches sweeping across faces, raised arms and the sheeting. Bodies read as silhouettes and brief flashes. Extreme grain, almost monochrome, handheld at chest height inside the crowd. Energy building through the shot. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THEY CUT THE POWER

63 down to 26 in three and a half seconds – the steepest fall in the film. Not the caps this time: the meter stopped agreeing with them, so the room stops existing, and the picture starts corrupting on this frame and not one before. One object carries the whole beat – the single plug the dome runs on – so that a viewer who has followed nothing else can see what was done. It is pulled slowly, and the dome dies in the same frame as the pins clear the socket. The sleeve is the author's greatcoat, so the hand belongs to a side and not to a workman. Restored by a beast's hand at 2:24 in the matching shot.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static wide shot at night. A thick black industrial power cable runs across a concrete floor to a single heavy plug seated in a wall socket. Behind it, filling the background, a temporary structure of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting glows brightly from within, full of people. A hand in a black leather glove, the cuff of a heavy dark wool greatcoat at the wrist, closes around the plug and pulls it slowly and steadily out of the socket. As the pins clear the socket the glowing structure behind goes black in the same frame. Locked-off camera, no cut, no camera move, the plug and the lit structure both visible throughout. Bright before, near-total darkness after. Heavy grain, near-monochrome. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame.

3 — THE AFTERMATH

Hold longer than is comfortable. The telemetry sits at absolute zero for ten seconds here and the score is silent for all of it. THE NOTHING.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static wide of an emptied tabernacle at dawn – an octagonal chamber of raw pine framing hung with silver mylar sheeting, erected inside a larger dark hall. Candles burned out and smoking, floor cushions stacked against a timber strut, house fluorescents up hard, nobody there. No movement at all except one thread of candle smoke. Cold flat light, heavy grain, near-monochrome. Locked off, no cut. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THEY PLUG IT BACK IN

The one shot that makes the recovery physical. Everything else in Act V is the consequence; this is the act. It reads at a glance because it is the earlier shot run backwards with a different arm in it, and it costs a second and a half each from the lunar room and the van portrait.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static wide shot at night, a thick black industrial power cable lying across a concrete floor beside a wall socket. Behind it, filling the background, a temporary structure of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting stands completely dark. A large clawed hand covered in coarse dark fur closes around the heavy plug and pushes it firmly into the socket. As the pins seat, the structure behind floods with bright light in the same frame and stays lit. Locked-off camera, no cut, no camera move, the plug and the structure both visible throughout. Near-total darkness before, bright glowing light after. Heavy grain, near-monochrome. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.